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Courtesy: UAE Presidential Court

MOHAMMAD VISITS KHALIFA BIN ZAYED II AIRBORNE BRIGADE COMMAND

President His Highness Shaikh Mohammad Bin Zayed Al Nahyan speaks with a member of the UAE Armed Forces, during a visit to the Khalifa Bin Zayed II Airborne Brigade Command, at Nad Al Sheba Military Camp in Dubai yesterday.

Dubai tourism ready for global headwinds

Emirate saw a 3% year-on-year increase in overnight visitors in Q1-2025

DUBAI
BY DHANUSHA GOKULAN
Chief Reporter

Dubai's tourism sector remains confident in its ability to navigate global economic headwinds, citing the city's established position, diversified offerings, and agility. Speaking ahead of the Arabian Travel Market (ATM), Issam Kazim, CEO of Dubai Corporation for Tourism and Commerce Marketing, emphasised Dubai's resilience.

"Dubai is very well positioned to ride this wave," Kazim said. "The diversified approach we've created also helps us in this."

Raising the benchmark

Dubai saw a 3 per cent year-on-year increase in overnight visitors in Q1-2025, building on a record 2023 and a strong 2024 that saw 18.72 million visitors. "So far, the first quarter of this year is 3 per cent ahead, which means we keep raising the benchmark," Kazim added.

Despite global challenges — including US-China trade tensions and market volatility — industry sentiment remains optimistic. Haitham Mattar of IHG Hotels & Resorts called it

a "period of adjustment" but praised Dubai's strategic positioning and long-term appeal.

Meanwhile, Emirates Airline is reporting stronger demand for April and May compared to last year. Chief Commercial Officer Adnan Kazim said the airline is used to navigating disruptions and is seeing positive booking trends despite global uncertainties. He added that the airline's ability to adapt swiftly is a key factor in maintaining momentum.

With resilient infrastructure, rising visitation, and close collaboration between public and private sectors, Dubai continues to demonstrate its ability to adapt and lead in a volatile global tourism landscape.

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Modi vows to pursue killers to 'ends of earth'

INDIA, PAKISTAN TAKE DIPLOMATIC MEASURES AFTER KASHMIR ATTACK

PATNA

Indian Prime Minister Narendra Modi vowed yesterday to punish all those responsible for the worst attack on civilians in Indian-administered Kashmir for a quarter of a century.

"I say to the whole world: India will identify, track and punish every terrorist and their backer," he said in his first speech since the attack in the Himalayan region. "We will pursue them to the ends of the Earth".

Modi led two minutes of silence in memory of those killed, who were all Indian, except one Nepali. "I say this unequivocally: whoever has carried out this attack, and the ones who devised it, will be made to pay beyond their imagination", Modi said, speaking in Hindi in front of a large crowd. "They will certainly pay. Whatever little land these terrorists have, it's time to reduce it to dust. The willpower of 1.4 billion Indians will break the backbone of these terrorists."

Seeking justice

Modi finished his speech in English, addressing an audience abroad. "Terrorism will not go unpunished," he said. "Every effort will be made to ensure that justice is done."

Earlier on Wednesday, India took a raft of diplomatic measures against Pakistan, accusing Islamabad of supporting "cross-border terrorism" after the deadly attack on civilians in Pahalgam.

After India annulled the Indus Valley Treaty signed in 1960 and suspended visas to Pakistanis, Islamabad suspended the Shimla Agreement signed with Indian in 1972 after the India-Pakistan war, among other things.

They included the suspension of the Indus Waters Treaty of 1960 to share critical water from Himalayan tributaries. They also included the shutting of the main land border crossing and diplomatic staff reductions, including withdrawing several Indian personnel from Islamabad and ordering Pakistanis home.

Pakistan, which has denied responsibility, later responded with a slew of measures which included expelling Indian diplomats and cancelling visas for Indian nationals with the exception of Sikh pilgrims.

Pakistan warned that it would consider any attempt by India to stop the supply of water from the Indus River an "act of war". Islamabad said Indian military advisers were "persona non grata". Pakistan's airspace was also closed with immediate effect "for all Indian owned or Indian operated airlines", while the main Wagah border crossing in Punjab was also closed.

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